

Combinatorial Solving with Provably Correct Results

Lecture 2

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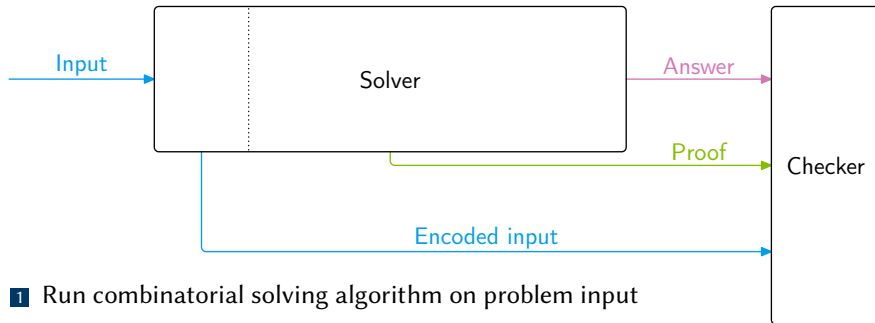
Topics in Algorithms and Complexity

University of Copenhagen

October 6, 2026

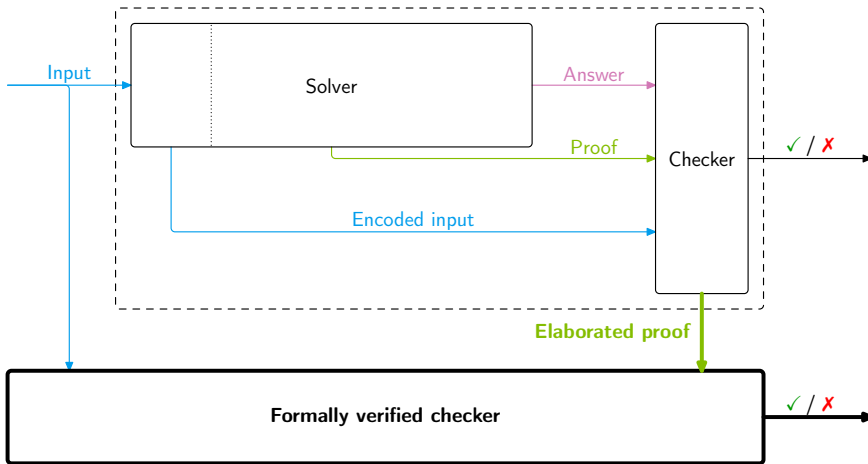


Recap of Proof Logging Workflow (1/2)



- 1 Run combinatorial solving algorithm on problem input
- 2 Get as output not only answer but also proof
- 3 Feed answer + proof to proof checker together with 0-1 ILP encoding of input

Recap of Proof Logging Workflow (2/2)



Implementation and Performance

Proof logging implementation

- Don't change solver
- Just add proof logging statements (plus some book-keeping)
- Proof generation should be very efficient

Performance goals for proof checking

Want linear(ish) scaling in terms of original **solver running time** for

- **proof size**
- **proof checking time**

VERIPB Proof Structure

1 Preamble

Specify

- VERIPB proof version
- # input constraints (optional)

2 Derivation section

The actual proof

Derivations of new constraints

Logging of solutions

3 Output section

List of constraints currently in database (optional)

Input to next stage (or for debugging)

4 Conclusions section

Specification of what was proven

- satisfiability / unsatisfiability
- optimality (or upper and lower bounds)
- enumeration of solutions
- other types of conclusions (future)

VERIPB Proof Structure: Syntax

pseudo-Boolean proof version 3.0

f $\langle M \rangle$;

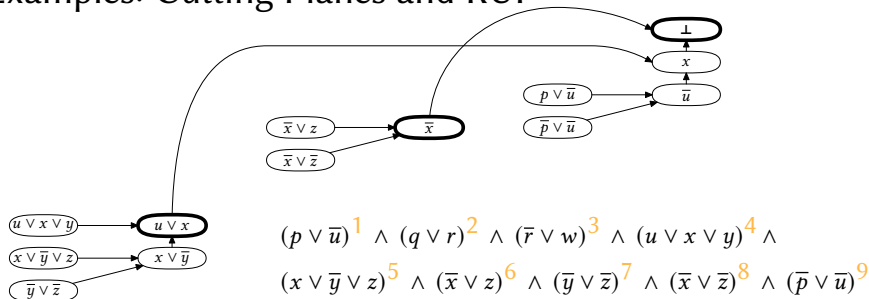
$\langle derivation part \rangle$

output $\langle output part \rangle$

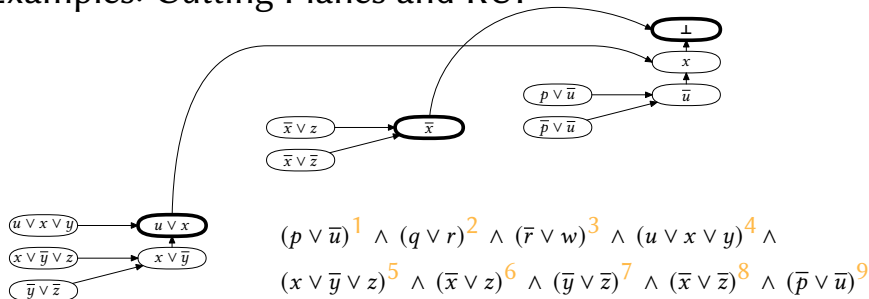
conclusion $\langle conclusion part \rangle$

end pseudo-Boolean proof ;

CDCL Proof Examples: Cutting Planes and RUP



CDCL Proof Examples: Cutting Planes and RUP



pol 7 5 + 2 d 4 + 2 d ;

pol 8 6 + 2 d ;

pol 9 1 + 2 d 10 + 2 d 11 + 2 d ;

$\rightsquigarrow$ Constraint 10 $\doteq u + x \geq 1$

$\rightsquigarrow$ Constraint 11 $\doteq \bar{x} \geq 1$

$\rightsquigarrow$ Constraint 12 $\doteq 0 \geq 1$ ⚡

VERIPB Proof Configuration

Core set $\mathcal{C}$

- Contains input formula at the start
- Input constraints can be modified (e.g., during preprocessing)
- But “equivalence” with input formula maintained

Derived set $\mathcal{D}$

- All constraints derived during search
- Also intermediate constraints used in proof logging [but not used by solver]
- Any satisfying assignment to $\mathcal{C}$ can be extended to $\mathcal{D}$

Disjunctive clause C is **RUP** w.r.t F if

- assigning C to false
- then unit propagating on F until saturation
- leads to contradiction

RUP for Pseudo-Boolean Constraints: Example

Is $D \doteq \overline{geq}_{11} + \overline{lt}_{11} \geq 1$ (i.e., $geq_{11} \Rightarrow \overline{lt}_{11}$) RUP with respect to $\{C_1, C_2\}$ below?

$$C_1 \doteq 11\overline{geq}_{11} + 8b_3 + 4b_2 + 2b_1 + b_0 \geq 11 \quad \text{i.e., } geq_{11} \Rightarrow (8b_3 + 4b_2 + 2b_1 + b_0 \geq 11)$$

$$C_2 \doteq 5\overline{lt}_{11} + 8\overline{b}_3 + 4\overline{b}_2 + 2\overline{b}_1 + \overline{b}_0 \geq 5 \quad \text{i.e., } lt_{11} \Rightarrow (8\overline{b}_3 + 4\overline{b}_2 + 2\overline{b}_1 + \overline{b}_0 \geq 5)$$

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$$\neg D \doteq geq_{11} + lt_{11} \geq 2 \quad \text{i.e., } geq_{11} \wedge lt_{11}$$

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$$C_1 \doteq 11\overline{geq}_{11} + 8b_3 + 4b_2 + 2b_1 + b_0 \geq 11 \quad \text{slack} = 0$$

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Unit propagation setting literals **true** or **false**:

$$geq_{11} \stackrel{\neg D}{=} 1, \quad lt_{11} \stackrel{\neg D}{=} 1, \quad b_3 \stackrel{C_1}{=} 1, \quad b_2 \stackrel{C_2}{=} 0$$

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RUP for Pseudo-Boolean Constraints: Example

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$$\neg D \doteq geq_{11} + lt_{11} \geq 2 \quad \text{slack} = 0$$

Unit propagation setting literals **true** or **false**:

$$geq_{11} \stackrel{\neg D}{=} 1, \quad lt_{11} \stackrel{\neg D}{=} 1, \quad b_3 \stackrel{C_1}{=} 1, \quad \textcolor{violet}{b}_2 \stackrel{C_2}{=} 0, \quad b_1 \stackrel{C_1}{=} 1, \quad b_0 \stackrel{C_1}{=} 1, \quad \textcolor{violet}{\perp}^{C_2}$$

$$C_3 \doteq x_2 + x_3 \geq 1$$

$$|_S D \doteq x_1 +$$

$$\neg D \doteq \bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_2 + \bar{x}_3 \geq 2 \quad \text{slack} = 1$$

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But D is implied – any assignment satisfying $\{C_1, C_2, C_3\}$ must also satisfy $x_1 + x_2 + x_3 \geq 2$

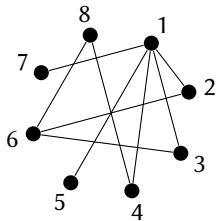
$$\neg D \doteq \bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_2 + \bar{x}_3 \geq 2 \quad \text{slack} = 1$$


```
dom ⟨Constraint C⟩ : ⟨var1⟩ -> ⟨val1⟩ . . . ⟨varN⟩ -> ⟨valN⟩ : subproof
  subproofs for proof goals
qed;
```

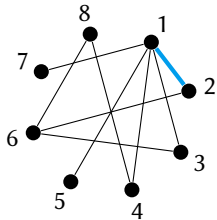
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More Advanced Example of Redundance-Based Strengthening

Is the following graph 2-colourable (bipartite)?



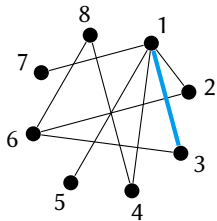
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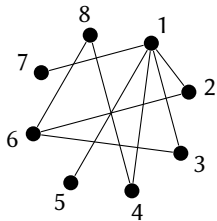
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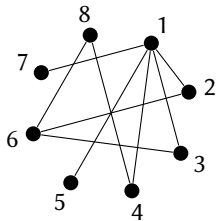
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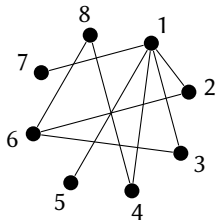
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Without loss of generality node 1 is blue
(otherwise we can swap the two colours)

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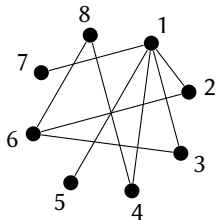
Without loss of generality node 1 is blue
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Derive $b_1 \geq 1$ with redundance rule;
witness $\omega : b_i \mapsto \bar{b}_i$ for all i

$$F \doteq F \upharpoonright_{\omega} \quad \text{and} \quad \neg(b_1 \geq 1) = (b_1 \geq 1) \upharpoonright_{\omega}$$

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pseudo-Boolean proof version 3.0

f 18 ;

red 1 b1 >= 1 : b1 -> ~b1 b2 -> ~b2

↪ b3 -> ~b3 b4 -> ~b4 b5 -> ~b5

↪ b6 -> ~b6 b7 -> ~b7 b8 -> ~b8 ;

rup >= 1 ;

output NONE ;

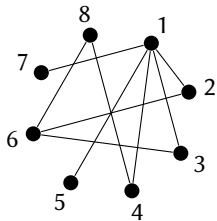
conclusion UNSAT ;

end pseudo-Boolean proof ;

■ Start the proof

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The Problem of Deleting Constraints

Important to allow deletions of constraints from database

- Improves practical performance
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Enumeration: deletion can reintroduce already enumerated solutions

The Problem of Deleting Constraints

Important to allow deletions of constraints from database

- Improves practical performance
- Affects power of strengthening rules

But powerful strengthening rules create problems:

- Unsatisfiable formulas can turn satisfiable
- Satisfiable formulas can turn unsatisfiable(!)

Optimisation: deletion can create too-good-to-be-true solutions

Enumeration: deletion can reintroduce already enumerated solutions

Solution: distinguish between deletion from core set $\mathcal{C}$ and derived set $\mathcal{D}$

Deletion, Core Transfer, and Order Change

Deletion

- 1 Deletion of constraint C **always OK from derived set $\mathcal{D}$**
- 2 **OK from core set $\mathcal{C}$ only if C can be rederived from $\mathcal{C} \setminus \{C\}$ with redundance rule**
(otherwise **unchecked deletion** — special conditions apply)

Similar to deletion rule in [JHB12] (but not implemented in DRAT)

Core transfer

Constraints from $\mathcal{D}$ can be moved to $\mathcal{C}$

Change of order

Possible to change order only if $\mathcal{D} = \emptyset$

Optimisation Problems

Any solution α found is logged with `sol i` “log solution and improve” command

- Provided solution α checked against current core set $\mathcal{C}$
- **Objective-improving constraint** $f \leq -1 + \sum_i w_i \cdot \alpha(\ell_i) + k$ added to core set (forces search for better solutions)

Note that

- α need not be solution for original formula
- but such solution can be reconstructed from the proof

Proof of optimality: Contradiction derived from objective-improving constraint

Proof format supports not just optimality, but also non-tight upper and lower bounds



Syntactic Sugar: Labels for Constraints

Constraint identifiers are consecutive numbers 1, 2, 3, ...

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Labels simplify things — just **aliases** `@⟨label⟩` for **constraint IDs** (in input file or proof file)

```
* input file (.opb)
```

```
@foo 1 x1 1 x2 >= 1 ;
```

```
@bar 1 x1 1 x3 >= 1 ;
```

```
@baz 1 x1 1 x3 >= 1 ;
```

```
% proof file (.pbp)
```

```
@sum pol @foo @bar + @baz + ;
```

```
pol @sum 2 d ;
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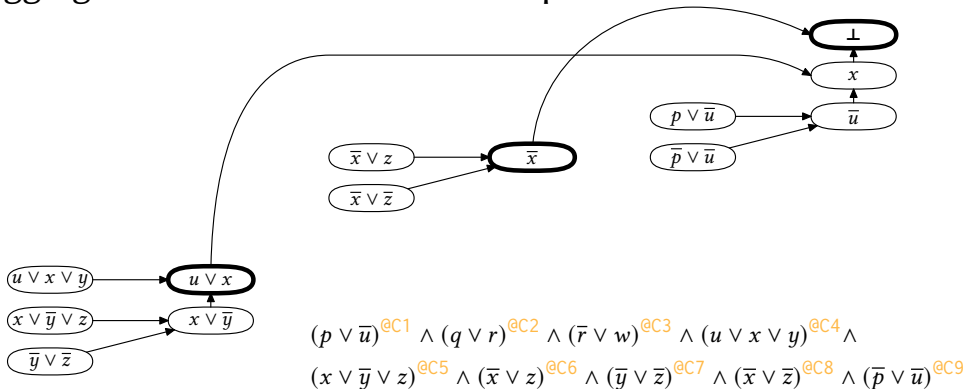
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- Can be used anywhere a constraint ID is expected
- Prefixing of proof rule assigns label to derived constraint
- Defining a label again just **overwrites** it — can be convenient when referring to simplified form of “the same constraint”

Proof Logging with Labels for CDCL Example



$$\rightsquigarrow 0 \geq 1 \quad \text{⚡}$$

Linear Pseudo-Boolean Constraints and Normalised Form

Usually, **pseudo-Boolean constraints** are any **0–1 integer linear constraints** on the form

$$\sum_i a_i \ell_i \bowtie A$$

- $\bowtie \in \{\geq, \leq, =, >, <\}$
- $a_i, A \in \mathbb{Z}$
- **literals** ℓ_i : x_i or $\bar{x}_i$ (where $x_i + \bar{x}_i = 1$)
- variables x_i take values $0 = \text{false}$ or $1 = \text{true}$

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For us, convenient to use **normalised form** [Bar95] (without loss of generality)

$$\sum_i a_i \ell_i \geq A$$

- constraint always greater-than-or-equal
- $a_i, A \in \mathbb{N}$ non-negative
- $A = \text{deg}(\sum_i a_i \ell_i \geq A)$ referred to as **degree (of falsity)**

Conversion to Normalised Form: Example

Normalised form is used for convenience and without loss of generality

$$-x_1 + 2x_2 - 3x_3 + 4x_4 - 5x_5 < 0$$

- 1 Make inequality non-strict

$$-x_1 + 2x_2 - 3x_3 + 4x_4 - 5x_5 \leq -1$$

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$$x_1 - 2x_2 + 3x_3 - 4x_4 + 5x_5 \geq 1$$

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- 3 Replace $-\ell$ by $-(1 - \bar{\ell})$ [where we define $\bar{\bar{x}} \doteq x$]

$$x_1 - 2(1 - \bar{x}_2) + 3x_3 - 4(1 - \bar{x}_4) + 5x_5 \geq 1$$

$$x_1 + 2\bar{x}_2 + 3x_3 + 4\bar{x}_4 + 5x_5 \geq 7$$

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- 4 Replace “=” by two inequalities “ $\geq$ ” and “ $\leq$ ”

Conversion to Normalised Form: Formal Details

Given (normalised) linear form $\sum_i a_i \ell_i$ with coefficient sum $\sum_i a_i = W$

Syntactic sugar

$$\sum_i a_i \ell_i > A$$

$$\sum_i a_i \ell_i \leq A$$

$$\sum_i a_i \ell_i < A$$

$$\sum_i a_i \ell_i = A$$

Meaning

$$\sum_i a_i \ell_i \geq A + 1$$

$$\sum_i a_i \bar{\ell}_i \geq W - A$$

$$\sum_i a_i \bar{\ell}_i \geq W - A + 1$$

$$\sum_i a_i \ell_i \geq A \quad \text{and}$$

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$$\sum_i a_i \ell_i \geq A \quad \text{and}$$

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In what follows:

- Use syntactic sugar when convenient
- Assume (implicit) normalisation whenever it matters
- Write $\doteq$ for syntactic equality

Some Convenient Notation for Constraints

Given constraint $C \doteq \sum_i a_i \ell_i \geq A$ with $\sum_i a_i = W$

Negation

$$\neg C \doteq \sum_i a_i \bar{\ell}_i \geq W - A + 1$$

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Reification

$$r \Rightarrow C \doteq A \cdot \bar{r} + \sum_i a_i \ell_i \geq A$$

$$r \Leftarrow C \doteq (W - A + 1) \cdot r + \sum_i a_i \bar{\ell}_i \geq W - A + 1$$

$$r \Leftrightarrow C \doteq r \Rightarrow C \text{ and } r \Leftarrow C$$

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$$r \Leftrightarrow C \doteq r \Rightarrow C \text{ and } r \Leftarrow C$$

Some calculations

$$r \Leftarrow C \doteq \bar{r} \Rightarrow \neg C$$

$$C + \neg C \doteq 0 \geq 1$$

$$\deg(C) \cdot (r \geq 1) + (r \Rightarrow C) \doteq C$$

$$C + (r \Leftarrow C) \doteq \deg(\neg C) \cdot r \geq 1$$

More Syntactic Sugar: Reification in VERIPB Syntax

For big-M reification constraints, can be annoying to compute the right constant

So VERIPB allows to **write reified constraints with arrows**

$r \implies \langle \text{constraint} \rangle ;$

$r \Leftarrow \langle \text{constraint} \rangle ;$

$r \iff \langle \text{constraint} \rangle ;$

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So VERIPB allows to **write reified constraints with arrows**

$r \implies \langle \text{constraint} \rangle ;$

$r \leq \langle \text{constraint} \rangle ;$

$r \iff \langle \text{constraint} \rangle ;$

- $\iff$ stands for two constraints and lives in the input file only
- $\leq$ and $\iff$ take **exactly one** literal on the left
- $\implies$ allows **one or more** literals, read as their **conjunction**

More Syntactic Sugar: Reification in VERIPB Syntax

For big-M reification constraints, can be annoying to compute the right constant

So VERIPB allows to **write reified constraints with arrows**

$$r \implies \langle \text{constraint} \rangle ;$$

$$r \leq \langle \text{constraint} \rangle ;$$

$$r \iff \langle \text{constraint} \rangle ;$$

- $\iff$ stands for two constraints and lives in the input file only
- $\leq$ and $\iff$ take **exactly one** literal on the left
- $\implies$ allows **one or more** literals, read as their **conjunction**

For $C \doteq \sum_i a_i \ell_i \geq A$ and literals $r_1, r_2, \dots, r_n$, we have

$$r_1 \wedge r_2 \wedge \dots \wedge r_n \implies C \doteq A\bar{r}_1 + A\bar{r}_2 + \dots + A\bar{r}_n + \sum_i a_i \ell_i \geq A$$

Reification in VERIPB Syntax: Concrete Examples

For $C \doteq x_1 + 2x_2 + 3x_3 + 4x_4 \geq 5$ we have

- $\text{deg}(C) = 5$
- $W = \sum_i a_i = 10$
- $\neg C \doteq \bar{x}_1 + 2\bar{x}_2 + 3\bar{x}_3 + 4\bar{x}_4 \geq 10 - 5 + 1$

Reification in VERIPB Syntax: Concrete Examples

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Syntactic sugar

$r \implies 1 \ x_1 \ 2 \ x_2 \ 3 \ x_3 \ 4 \ x_4 \geq 5 ;$

$r \leq 1 \ x_1 \ 2 \ x_2 \ 3 \ x_3 \ 4 \ x_4 \geq 5 ;$

$r \iff 1 \ x_1 \ 2 \ x_2 \ 3 \ x_3 \ 4 \ x_4 \geq 5 ;$

$r_1 \sim r_2 \ r_3 \implies 1 \ x_1 \ 2 \ x_2 \ 3 \ x_3 \ 4 \ x_4 \geq 5 ;$

Meaning

$5\bar{r} + x_1 + 2x_2 + 3x_3 + 4x_4 \geq 5$

$6r + \bar{x}_1 + 2\bar{x}_2 + 3\bar{x}_3 + 4\bar{x}_4 \geq 6$

1st and 2nd constraint, in that order

$5\bar{r}_1 + 5r_2 + 5\bar{r}_3 + x_1 + 2x_2 + 3x_3 + 4x_4 \geq 5$

Reification in VERIPB Syntax: Concrete Examples

For $C \doteq x_1 + 2x_2 + 3x_3 + 4x_4 \geq 5$ we have

- $\text{deg}(C) = 5$
- $W = \sum_i a_i = 10$
- $\neg C \doteq \bar{x}_1 + 2\bar{x}_2 + 3\bar{x}_3 + 4\bar{x}_4 \geq 6$

Syntactic sugar

$r \implies 1 \ x_1 \ 2 \ x_2 \ 3 \ x_3 \ 4 \ x_4 \geq 5 ;$

$r \leq 1 \ x_1 \ 2 \ x_2 \ 3 \ x_3 \ 4 \ x_4 \geq 5 ;$

$r \iff 1 \ x_1 \ 2 \ x_2 \ 3 \ x_3 \ 4 \ x_4 \geq 5 ;$ 1st and 2nd constraint, in that order

$r_1 \sim r_2 \ r_3 \implies 1 \ x_1 \ 2 \ x_2 \ 3 \ x_3 \ 4 \ x_4 \geq 5 ;$ $5\bar{r}_1 + 5r_2 + 5\bar{r}_3 + x_1 + 2x_2 + 3x_3 + 4x_4 \geq 5$

Meaning

$5\bar{r} + x_1 + 2x_2 + 3x_3 + 4x_4 \geq 5$

$6r + \bar{x}_1 + 2\bar{x}_2 + 3\bar{x}_3 + 4\bar{x}_4 \geq 6$

- Right reification: **negate reification literal(s)** and add with **coefficient $\text{deg}(C) = 5$**
- Left reification: **negate constraint** and add reification literal with **coefficient $\text{deg}(\neg C) = 6$**

Calculations with Reified Constraints: Concrete Examples

Still with $C \doteq x_1 + 2x_2 + 3x_3 + 4x_4 \geq 5$, so that $\neg C \doteq \bar{x}_1 + 2\bar{x}_2 + 3\bar{x}_3 + 4\bar{x}_4 \geq 6$
(and recall that $\ell + \bar{\ell} = 1$, so that opposing literals cancel and leave 1)

$$\begin{aligned} C + \neg C &\doteq (x_1 + \bar{x}_1) + 2(x_2 + \bar{x}_2) + 3(x_3 + \bar{x}_3) + 4(x_4 + \bar{x}_4) \geq 11 \\ &\doteq 0 \geq 11 - 10 \\ &\doteq 0 \geq 1 \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned} \text{deg}(C) \cdot (r \geq 1) + (r \Rightarrow C) &\doteq 5(r + \bar{r}) + x_1 + 2x_2 + 3x_3 + 4x_4 \geq 10 \\ &\doteq x_1 + 2x_2 + 3x_3 + 4x_4 \geq 10 - 5 \\ &\doteq C \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned} C + (r \Leftarrow C) &\doteq 6r + (x_1 + \bar{x}_1) + 2(x_2 + \bar{x}_2) + 3(x_3 + \bar{x}_3) + 4(x_4 + \bar{x}_4) \geq 11 \\ &\doteq 6r \geq 11 - 10 \\ &\doteq \text{deg}(\neg C) \cdot r \geq 1 \end{aligned}$$

Cutting Planes Derivations Under Assumptions

Suppose we have the constraints

$$r_1 + x_1 + x_2 \geq 1$$

$$r_1 + x_1 + x_3 \geq 1$$

$$x_2 + x_3 \geq 1$$

$$\bar{r}_2 + \bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_2 + \bar{x}_3 \geq 2$$

Cutting Planes Derivations Under Assumptions

Suppose we have the constraints

$$\cancel{r_1} + x_1 + x_2 \geq 1 \quad \rightsquigarrow \quad x_1 + x_2 \geq 1$$

$$\cancel{r_1} + x_1 + x_3 \geq 1 \quad \rightsquigarrow \quad x_1 + x_3 \geq 1$$

$$x_2 + x_3 \geq 1 \quad \rightsquigarrow \quad x_2 + x_3 \geq 1$$

$$\cancel{r_2} + \bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_2 + \bar{x}_3 \geq 2 \quad \rightsquigarrow \quad \bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_2 + \bar{x}_3 \geq 2$$

Assume $r_1 = 0$ and $r_2 = 1$ and simplify

Cutting Planes Derivations Under Assumptions

Suppose we have the constraints

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$$x_2 + x_3 \geq 1 \rightsquigarrow x_2 + x_3 \geq 1$$

$$\cancel{r_2} + \bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_2 + \bar{x}_3 \geq 2 \rightsquigarrow \bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_2 + \bar{x}_3 \geq 2$$

Assume $r_1 = 0$ and $r_2 = 1$ and simplify — then cutting planes can derive contradiction

$$\begin{array}{rcl}
 \text{Add} & \frac{x_1 + x_2 \geq 1 \quad x_1 + x_3 \geq 1}{2x_1 + x_2 + x_3 \geq 2} & x_2 + x_3 \geq 1 \\
 \text{Add} & \frac{2x_1 + x_2 + x_3 \geq 2 \quad x_2 + x_3 \geq 1}{2x_1 + 2x_2 + 2x_3 \geq 3} & \\
 \text{Divide by 2} & \frac{2x_1 + 2x_2 + 2x_3 \geq 3}{x_1 + x_2 + x_3 \geq 2} & \bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_2 + \bar{x}_3 \geq 2 \\
 \text{Add} & \frac{x_1 + x_2 + x_3 \geq 2 \quad \bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_2 + \bar{x}_3 \geq 2}{0 \geq 1} &
 \end{array}$$

Cutting Planes Derivations Under Assumptions

Suppose we have the constraints

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$$x_2 + x_3 \geq 1 \rightsquigarrow x_2 + x_3 \geq 1$$

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 \end{array}$$

This means that the original constraints imply $r_1 + \bar{r}_2 \geq 1$

The Same Derivation Without Assumptions

Now **forget about the assumptions** and **run exactly the same derivation** on the original constraints:

$$\begin{array}{l}
 \text{Add} \quad \frac{r_1 + x_1 + x_2 \geq 1 \quad r_1 + x_1 + x_3 \geq 1}{2r_1 + 2x_1 + x_2 + x_3 \geq 2 \quad x_2 + x_3 \geq 1} \\
 \text{Add} \quad \frac{2r_1 + 2x_1 + x_2 + x_3 \geq 2 \quad x_2 + x_3 \geq 1}{2r_1 + 2x_1 + 2x_2 + 2x_3 \geq 3} \\
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 \text{Add} \quad \frac{r_1 + x_1 + x_2 + x_3 \geq 2 \quad \bar{r}_2 + \bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_2 + \bar{x}_3 \geq 2}{r_1 + \bar{r}_2 \geq 1}
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 \end{array}$$

This yields

$$r_1 + \bar{r}_2 \geq 1 \quad [\text{VERIPB syntax: } 1 \ r1 \ 1 \ \sim r2 \ >= \ 1 \ ;]$$

or equivalently

$$\bar{r}_1 \wedge r_2 \Rightarrow (0 \geq 1) \quad [\text{VERIPB syntax: } \sim r1 \ r2 \ ==> \ >= \ 1 \ ;]$$

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That is, our assumptions imply contradiction

Derivations Under Assumptions: The General Claim

This works in general!

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■ Suppose that we have

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- 2 assumptions $\rho = \{\ell_1 = 1, \ell_2 = 1, \dots, \ell_n = 1\}$
- 3 cutting planes derivation of D from the restricted constraints $C_1 \upharpoonright_\rho, C_2 \upharpoonright_\rho, \dots, C_m \upharpoonright_\rho$
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- Then the same derivation applied to $C_1, C_2, \dots, C_m$ yields a constraint at least as strong as

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Give a convenient way to construct derivations:

- Apply assumptions in ρ to constraints C_j and simplify to get $C_j \upharpoonright_\rho$
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- Remove assumptions to get reified version $\rho \Rightarrow D$ of constraint

Derivations Under Assumptions: The General Claim

This works in general!

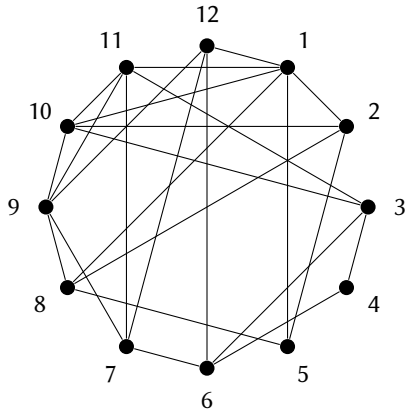
- Suppose that we have
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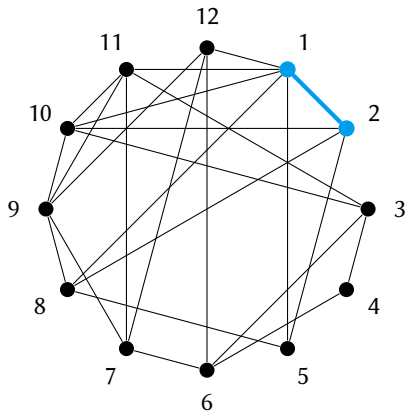
$$\ell_1 \wedge \ell_2 \wedge \dots \wedge \ell_n \Rightarrow D \doteq \deg(D) \cdot \sum_{i=1}^n \bar{\ell}_i + D$$

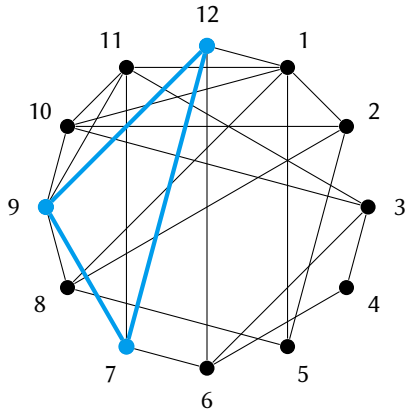
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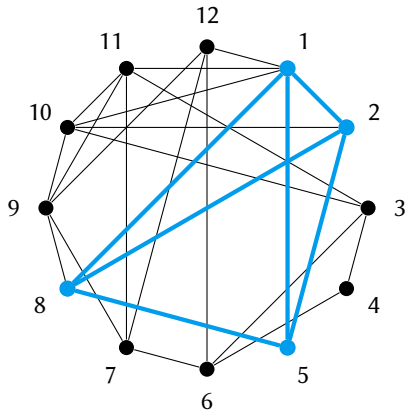
- Apply assumptions in ρ to constraints C_j and simplify to get $C_j \upharpoonright_\rho$
- Derive desired conclusion D
- Remove assumptions to get reified version $\rho \Rightarrow D$ of constraint
- Important special case: Backtracking clause from decisions/guesses leading to contradiction

Coming next, some worked examples from dedicated graph solvers









Topics '26 36/79

A Brief and Incomplete Guide to Clique Solving (2/4)

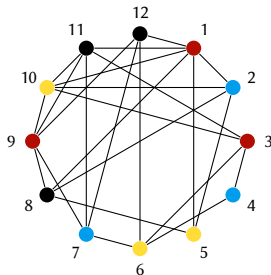
Key data structures:

- Growing clique C
- Shrinking set of potential vertices P
 - All the vertices we haven't thrown away yet
 - Every $v \in P$ is adjacent to every $w \in C$

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- Remember the biggest clique C^* found so far
- If $|C| + |P| \leq |C^*|$, no need to keep going

A Brief and Incomplete Guide to Clique Solving (3/4)



Given a k -colouring of a subgraph, that subgraph cannot have a clique of more than k vertices

We can use $|C| + \#colours(P)$ as a bound, for any colouring

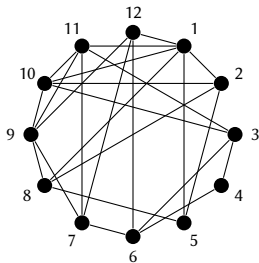
A Brief and Incomplete Guide to Clique Solving (4/4)

- This brings us to 1997
- Many improvements since then
 - better bound functions
 - clever vertex selection heuristics
 - efficient data structures
 - local search
 - ...
- But key ideas for proof logging can be explained without worrying about such things

Making a Certifying Clique Solver

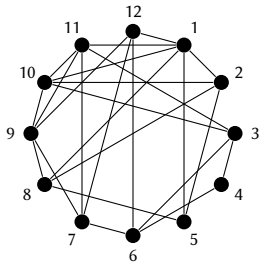
- 1 Output a pseudo-Boolean encoding of the problem
 - Clique problems have several standard file formats
 - Give the constraints labels, so the proof can refer to them by name
- 2 Make solver generate proof log for search tree
 - Output a small header
 - Output something on every backtrack
 - Output something every time a solution is found
 - Output a small footer
- 3 Figure out how to certify the bound function

A Pseudo-Boolean Encoding for Clique (in OPB Format)



```
* #variable= 12 #constraint= 41
min: 1 ~x1 1 ~x2 1 ~x3 1 ~x4 . . . and so on . . . 1 ~x11 1 ~x12 ;
@noedge1_3 -1 x3 -1 x1 >= -1 ;
@noedge2_3 -1 x3 -1 x2 >= -1 ;
@noedge1_4 -1 x4 -1 x1 >= -1 ;
* . . . and a further 38 similar lines for the remaining non-edges
```

A Pseudo-Boolean Encoding for Clique (in OPB Format)



* #variable= 12 #constraint= 41

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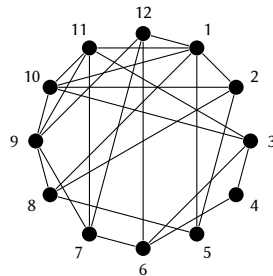
$x_i = 1$ means “vertex i is in the clique”

VERIPB proof minimises number of vertices **not** selected, so 4-clique yields objective value $12 - 4 = 8$

First Attempt at a Proof

pseudo-Boolean proof version 3.0

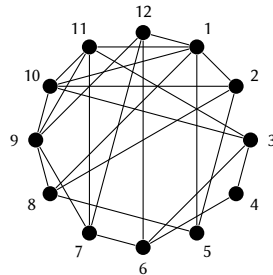
```
@obj soli x7 x9 x12 ;  
rup 1 ~x12 1 ~x7 >= 1 ;  
rup 1 ~x12 >= 1 ;  
rup 1 ~x11 1 ~x10 >= 1 ;  
rup 1 ~x11 >= 1 ;  
@obj soli x1 x2 x5 x8 ;  
rup 1 ~x8 1 ~x5 >= 1 ;  
rup 1 ~x8 >= 1 ;  
rup >= 1 ;  
output NONE ;  
conclusion BOUNDS 8 8 ;  
end pseudo-Boolean proof ;
```



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pseudo-Boolean proof version 3.0

```
@obj soli x7 x9 x12 ;  
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output NONE ;  
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end pseudo-Boolean proof ;
```



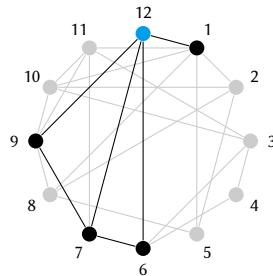
Start with a header

The problem constraints are loaded for us

First Attempt at a Proof

pseudo-Boolean proof version 3.0

```
@obj soli x7 x9 x12 ;  
rup 1 ~x12 1 ~x7 >= 1 ;  
rup 1 ~x12 >= 1 ;  
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rup 1 ~x8 1 ~x5 >= 1 ;  
rup 1 ~x8 >= 1 ;  
rup >= 1 ;  
output NONE ;  
conclusion BOUNDS 8 8 ;  
end pseudo-Boolean proof ;
```

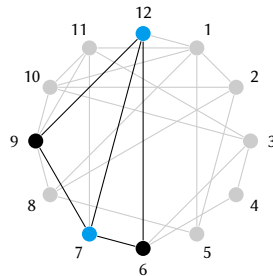


Branch accepting 12
Throw away non-adjacent vertices

First Attempt at a Proof

pseudo-Boolean proof version 3.0

```
@obj soli x7 x9 x12 ;  
rup 1 ~x12 1 ~x7 >= 1 ;  
rup 1 ~x12 >= 1 ;  
rup 1 ~x11 1 ~x10 >= 1 ;  
rup 1 ~x11 >= 1 ;  
@obj soli x1 x2 x5 x8 ;  
rup 1 ~x8 1 ~x5 >= 1 ;  
rup 1 ~x8 >= 1 ;  
rup >= 1 ;  
output NONE ;  
conclusion BOUNDS 8 8 ;  
end pseudo-Boolean proof ;
```

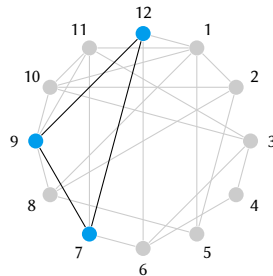


Branch also accepting 7
Throw away non-adjacent vertices

First Attempt at a Proof

pseudo-Boolean proof version 3.0

```
@obj soli x7 x9 x12 ;  
rup 1 ~x12 1 ~x7 >= 1 ;  
rup 1 ~x12 >= 1 ;  
rup 1 ~x11 1 ~x10 >= 1 ;  
rup 1 ~x11 >= 1 ;  
@obj soli x1 x2 x5 x8 ;  
rup 1 ~x8 1 ~x5 >= 1 ;  
rup 1 ~x8 >= 1 ;  
rup >= 1 ;  
output NONE ;  
conclusion BOUNDS 8 8 ;  
end pseudo-Boolean proof ;
```

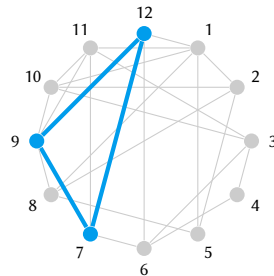


Branch also accepting 9
Throw away non-adjacent vertices

First Attempt at a Proof

pseudo-Boolean proof version 3.0

```
@obj soli x7 x9 x12 ;  
rup 1 ~x12 1 ~x7 >= 1 ;  
rup 1 ~x12 >= 1 ;  
rup 1 ~x11 1 ~x10 >= 1 ;  
rup 1 ~x11 >= 1 ;  
@obj soli x1 x2 x5 x8 ;  
rup 1 ~x8 1 ~x5 >= 1 ;  
rup 1 ~x8 >= 1 ;  
rup >= 1 ;  
output NONE ;  
conclusion BOUNDS 8 8 ;  
end pseudo-Boolean proof ;
```



We branched on 12, 7, 9
Found a new incumbent
Now looking for a ≥ 4 vertex clique
“@obj” names the constraint this creates

First Attempt at a Proof

pseudo-Boolean proof version 3.0

```
@obj soli x7 x9 x12 ;
```

```
rup 1 ~x12 1 ~x7 >= 1 ;
```

```
rup 1 ~x12 >= 1 ;
```

```
rup 1 ~x11 1 ~x10 >= 1 ;
```

```
rup 1 ~x11 >= 1 ;
```

```
@obj soli x1 x2 x5 x8 ;
```

```
rup 1 ~x8 1 ~x5 >= 1 ;
```

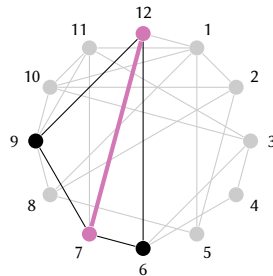
```
rup 1 ~x8 >= 1 ;
```

```
rup >= 1 ;
```

```
output NONE ;
```

```
conclusion BOUNDS 8 8 ;
```

```
end pseudo-Boolean proof ;
```

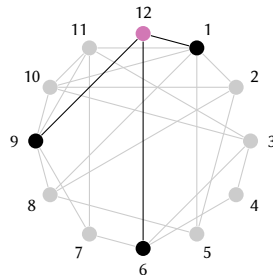


Backtrack from 12, 7
9 explored already, only 6 feasible
No ≥ 4 vertex clique possible
Effectively this deletes the 7–12 edge

First Attempt at a Proof

pseudo-Boolean proof version 3.0

```
@obj soli x7 x9 x12 ;  
rup 1 ~x12 1 ~x7 >= 1 ;  
rup 1 ~x12 >= 1 ;  
rup 1 ~x11 1 ~x10 >= 1 ;  
rup 1 ~x11 >= 1 ;  
@obj soli x1 x2 x5 x8 ;  
rup 1 ~x8 1 ~x5 >= 1 ;  
rup 1 ~x8 >= 1 ;  
rup >= 1 ;  
output NONE ;  
conclusion BOUNDS 8 8 ;  
end pseudo-Boolean proof ;
```

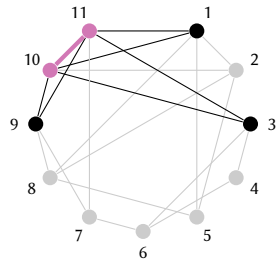


Backtrack from 12
Only 1, 6 and 9 feasible (1-colourable)
No ≥ 4 vertex clique possible
Effectively this deletes vertex 12

First Attempt at a Proof

pseudo-Boolean proof version 3.0

```
@obj soli x7 x9 x12 ;  
rup 1 ~x12 1 ~x7 >= 1 ;  
rup 1 ~x12 >= 1 ;  
rup 1 ~x11 1 ~x10 >= 1 ;  
rup 1 ~x11 >= 1 ;  
@obj soli x1 x2 x5 x8 ;  
rup 1 ~x8 1 ~x5 >= 1 ;  
rup 1 ~x8 >= 1 ;  
rup >= 1 ;  
output NONE ;  
conclusion BOUNDS 8 8 ;  
end pseudo-Boolean proof ;
```

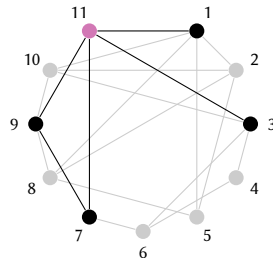


Branch on 11 then 10
Only 1, 3 and 9 feasible (1-colourable)
No ≥ 4 vertex clique possible
Backtrack, deleting the edge

First Attempt at a Proof

pseudo-Boolean proof version 3.0

```
@obj soli x7 x9 x12 ;  
rup 1 ~x12 1 ~x7 >= 1 ;  
rup 1 ~x12 >= 1 ;  
rup 1 ~x11 1 ~x10 >= 1 ;  
rup 1 ~x11 >= 1 ;  
@obj soli x1 x2 x5 x8 ;  
rup 1 ~x8 1 ~x5 >= 1 ;  
rup 1 ~x8 >= 1 ;  
rup >= 1 ;  
output NONE ;  
conclusion BOUNDS 8 8 ;  
end pseudo-Boolean proof ;
```

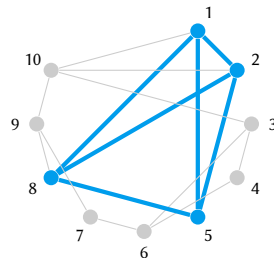


Backtrack from 11
2-colourable, so no ≥ 4 clique
Delete the vertex

First Attempt at a Proof

pseudo-Boolean proof version 3.0

```
@obj soli x7 x9 x12 ;  
rup 1 ~x12 1 ~x7 >= 1 ;  
rup 1 ~x12 >= 1 ;  
rup 1 ~x11 1 ~x10 >= 1 ;  
rup 1 ~x11 >= 1 ;  
@obj soli x1 x2 x5 x8 ;  
rup 1 ~x8 1 ~x5 >= 1 ;  
rup 1 ~x8 >= 1 ;  
rup >= 1 ;  
output NONE ;  
conclusion BOUNDS 8 8 ;  
end pseudo-Boolean proof ;
```

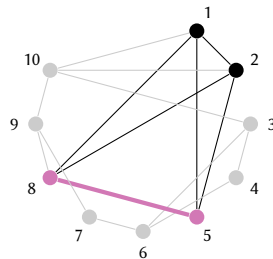


Branch on 8, 5, 1, 2
Find a new incumbent
Now looking for a ≥ 5 vertex clique

First Attempt at a Proof

pseudo-Boolean proof version 3.0

```
@obj soli x7 x9 x12 ;  
rup 1 ~x12 1 ~x7 >= 1 ;  
rup 1 ~x12 >= 1 ;  
rup 1 ~x11 1 ~x10 >= 1 ;  
rup 1 ~x11 >= 1 ;  
@obj soli x1 x2 x5 x8 ;  
rup 1 ~x8 1 ~x5 >= 1 ;  
rup 1 ~x8 >= 1 ;  
rup >= 1 ;  
output NONE ;  
conclusion BOUNDS 8 8 ;  
end pseudo-Boolean proof ;
```

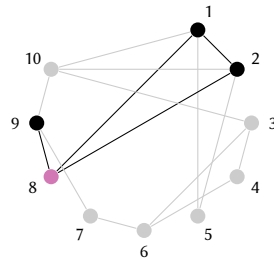


Backtrack from 8, 5
Only 4 vertices; can't have a ≥ 5 clique
Delete the edge

First Attempt at a Proof

pseudo-Boolean proof version 3.0

```
@obj soli x7 x9 x12 ;  
rup 1 ~x12 1 ~x7 >= 1 ;  
rup 1 ~x12 >= 1 ;  
rup 1 ~x11 1 ~x10 >= 1 ;  
rup 1 ~x11 >= 1 ;  
@obj soli x1 x2 x5 x8 ;  
rup 1 ~x8 1 ~x5 >= 1 ;  
rup 1 ~x8 >= 1 ;  
rup >= 1 ;  
output NONE ;  
conclusion BOUNDS 8 8 ;  
end pseudo-Boolean proof ;
```

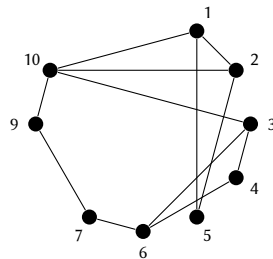


Backtrack from 8
Still not enough vertices
Delete the vertex

First Attempt at a Proof

pseudo-Boolean proof version 3.0

```
@obj soli x7 x9 x12 ;  
rup 1 ~x12 1 ~x7 >= 1 ;  
rup 1 ~x12 >= 1 ;  
rup 1 ~x11 1 ~x10 >= 1 ;  
rup 1 ~x11 >= 1 ;  
@obj soli x1 x2 x5 x8 ;  
rup 1 ~x8 1 ~x5 >= 1 ;  
rup 1 ~x8 >= 1 ;  
rup >= 1 ;  
output NONE ;  
conclusion BOUNDS 8 8 ;  
end pseudo-Boolean proof ;
```



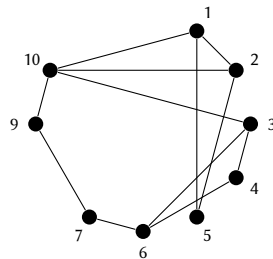
Remaining graph is 3-colourable
Backtrack from root node

First Attempt at a Proof

pseudo-Boolean proof version 3.0

```
@obj soli x7 x9 x12 ;  
rup 1 ~x12 1 ~x7 >= 1 ;  
rup 1 ~x12 >= 1 ;  
rup 1 ~x11 1 ~x10 >= 1 ;  
rup 1 ~x11 >= 1 ;  
@obj soli x1 x2 x5 x8 ;  
rup 1 ~x8 1 ~x5 >= 1 ;  
rup 1 ~x8 >= 1 ;  
rup >= 1 ;
```

```
output NONE ;  
conclusion BOUNDS 8 8 ;  
end pseudo-Boolean proof ;
```



Finish with what we've concluded
We specify a lower and an upper bound
Remember we're minimising the number of vertices we *don't* select, so a 4-clique has an objective value of $12 - 4 = 8$
("output" is for features we're not using)

Verifying This Proof (Or Not...)

```
$ veripb clique.opb clique-attempt-one.pbp
Running VeriPB version 3.0.2
Error: Checking error at clique-attempt-one.pbp:5
```

Caused by:

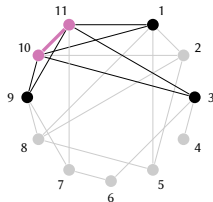
```
The constraint is not implied by reverse unit propagation
(RUP) from core and derived database. Rerun with the option
'--trace-failed' to see the propagations. . . .
```

Verifying This Proof (Or Not...)

```
$ veripb clique.opb clique-attempt-one.pbp
Running VeriPB version 3.0.2
Error: Checking error at clique-attempt-one.pbp:5
```

Caused by:

The constraint is not implied by reverse unit propagation (RUP) from core and derived database. Rerun with the option '--trace-failed' to see the propagations. . . .



Verifying This Proof (Or Not...)

```
$ veripb --trace clique.opb clique-attempt-one.pbp
Running VeriPB version 3.0.2
  Objective: min 1 ~x1 1 ~x2 . . . 1 ~x11 1 ~x12 0
  ConstraintId 1: 1 ~x1 1 ~x3 >= 1
  ConstraintId 2: 1 ~x2 1 ~x3 >= 1
  . . .
  ConstraintId 41: 1 ~x11 1 ~x12 >= 1
line   1: pseudo-Boolean proof version 3.0
line   2: @obj soli x7 x9 x12 ;
  ConstraintId 42: 1 x1 1 x2 . . . 1 x11 1 x12 >= 4
line   3: rup 1 ~x12 1 ~x7 >= 1 ;
  ConstraintId 43: 1 ~x7 1 ~x12 >= 1
line   4: rup 1 ~x12 >= 1 ;
  ConstraintId 44: 1 ~x12 >= 1
line   5: rup 1 ~x11 1 ~x10 >= 1 ;
Error: Checking error at clique-attempt-one.pbp:5
```

Verifying This Proof (Or Not...)

```
$ veripb --trace-failed clique.opb clique-attempt-one.pbp
Running VeriPB version 3.0.2
Propagation check failed! The propagation had the following trail:
  propagations in format: <assignment> (<reason constraint>)
    ~x12 (1 ~x12 >= 1)
    x10 (1 x10 1 x11 >= 2)
    x11 (1 x10 1 x11 >= 2)
    ~x4 (1 ~x4 1 ~x10 >= 1)
    ~x5 (1 ~x5 1 ~x10 >= 1)
    ~x6 (1 ~x6 1 ~x10 >= 1)
    ~x7 (1 ~x7 1 ~x10 >= 1)
    ~x8 (1 ~x8 1 ~x10 >= 1)
    ~x2 (1 ~x2 1 ~x11 >= 1)
Error: Checking error at clique-attempt-one.pbp:5
```

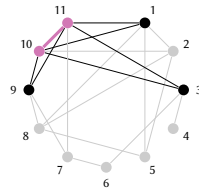
The Problem of Counting

The proof checker isn't smart enough to work out that

- vertices 1, 3 and 9 can all be given the same colour...
- and each colour class contributes at most one vertex to a clique...
- so “find me a clique with more than three vertices” can't be satisfied once we've accepted both 10 and 11

Unit propagation never sees this:

- The bound needs **counting**
- But the encoding only ever talks about **pairs** of vertices



Dealing With Colourings

So the colour bound doesn't follow by reverse unit propagation...

But we can lazily recover at-most-one constraints for each colour class!

Dealing With Colourings

So the colour bound doesn't follow by reverse unit propagation...

But we can lazily recover at-most-one constraints for each colour class!

$$\begin{aligned}
 &(\bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_6 \geq 1) \\
 + &(\bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_9 \geq 1) &&= 2\bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_6 + \bar{x}_9 \geq 2 \\
 + &(\bar{x}_6 + \bar{x}_9 \geq 1) &&= 2\bar{x}_1 + 2\bar{x}_6 + 2\bar{x}_9 \geq 3 \\
 &&&/ 2 &&= \bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_6 + \bar{x}_9 \geq 2 \\
 &&&&&\text{i.e. } x_1 + x_6 + x_9 \leq 1
 \end{aligned}$$

Dealing With Colourings

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But we can lazily recover at-most-one constraints for each colour class!

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 &(\bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_6 \geq 1) \\
 + &(\bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_9 \geq 1) &&= 2\bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_6 + \bar{x}_9 \geq 2 \\
 + &(\bar{x}_6 + \bar{x}_9 \geq 1) &&= 2\bar{x}_1 + 2\bar{x}_6 + 2\bar{x}_9 \geq 3 \\
 &&&/ 2 &&= \bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_6 + \bar{x}_9 \geq 2 \\
 &&&&&\text{i.e. } x_1 + x_6 + x_9 \leq 1
 \end{aligned}$$

This generalises to colour classes of any size v

- Each non-edge is used exactly once, $v(v-1)$ additions
- $v-3$ multiplications and $v-2$ divisions

Solvers don't need to "understand" cutting planes to write out this derivation

Details on At-Most-One Constraint Recovery (3 Variables)

- Derive constraint $x_1 + \dots + x_n \leq 1$ from $\binom{n}{2}$ constraints $x_i + x_j \leq 1$
- I.e., $\bar{x}_1 + \dots + \bar{x}_n \geq n - 1$ from constraints $\bar{x}_i + \bar{x}_j \geq 1$ in normalised form
- Need this to prove that **at most one vertex per colour class** can be a member of the clique

Details on At-Most-One Constraint Recovery (3 Variables)

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- Need this to prove that **at most one vertex per colour class** can be a member of the clique

$$\text{Add} \quad \frac{\bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_2 \geq 1 \quad \bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_3 \geq 1}{2\bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_2 + \bar{x}_3 \geq 2}$$

Details on At-Most-One Constraint Recovery (3 Variables)

- Derive constraint $x_1 + \dots + x_n \leq 1$ from $\binom{n}{2}$ constraints $x_i + x_j \leq 1$
- I.e., $\bar{x}_1 + \dots + \bar{x}_n \geq n - 1$ from constraints $\bar{x}_i + \bar{x}_j \geq 1$ in normalised form
- Need this to prove that **at most one vertex per colour class** can be a member of the clique

$$\begin{array}{rcl}
 & \bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_2 \geq 1 & \bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_3 \geq 1 \\
 \text{Add} & \hline
 & 2\bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_2 + \bar{x}_3 \geq 2 & \bar{x}_2 + \bar{x}_3 \geq 1 \\
 \text{Add} & \hline
 & 2\bar{x}_1 + 2\bar{x}_2 + 2\bar{x}_3 \geq 3
 \end{array}$$

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- Derive constraint $x_1 + \dots + x_n \leq 1$ from $\binom{n}{2}$ constraints $x_i + x_j \leq 1$
- I.e., $\bar{x}_1 + \dots + \bar{x}_n \geq n - 1$ from constraints $\bar{x}_i + \bar{x}_j \geq 1$ in normalised form
- Need this to prove that **at most one vertex per colour class** can be a member of the clique

$$\begin{array}{rcl}
 & \bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_2 \geq 1 & \bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_3 \geq 1 \\
 \text{Add} & \hline
 & 2\bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_2 + \bar{x}_3 \geq 2 & \bar{x}_2 + \bar{x}_3 \geq 1 \\
 \text{Add} & \hline
 & 2\bar{x}_1 + 2\bar{x}_2 + 2\bar{x}_3 \geq 3 \\
 \text{Divide by 2} & \hline
 & \bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_2 + \bar{x}_3 \geq \frac{3}{2}
 \end{array}$$

Details on At-Most-One Constraint Recovery (3 Variables)

- Derive constraint $x_1 + \dots + x_n \leq 1$ from $\binom{n}{2}$ constraints $x_i + x_j \leq 1$
- I.e., $\bar{x}_1 + \dots + \bar{x}_n \geq n - 1$ from constraints $\bar{x}_i + \bar{x}_j \geq 1$ in normalised form
- Need this to prove that **at most one vertex per colour class** can be a member of the clique

$$\begin{array}{rcl}
 & \bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_2 \geq 1 & \bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_3 \geq 1 \\
 \text{Add} & \hline
 & 2\bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_2 + \bar{x}_3 \geq 2 & \bar{x}_2 + \bar{x}_3 \geq 1 \\
 \text{Add} & \hline
 & 2\bar{x}_1 + 2\bar{x}_2 + 2\bar{x}_3 \geq 3 \\
 \text{Divide by 2} & \hline
 & \bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_2 + \bar{x}_3 \geq \left\lceil \frac{3}{2} \right\rceil
 \end{array}$$

Details on At-Most-One Constraint Recovery (3 Variables)

- Derive constraint $x_1 + \dots + x_n \leq 1$ from $\binom{n}{2}$ constraints $x_i + x_j \leq 1$
- I.e., $\bar{x}_1 + \dots + \bar{x}_n \geq n - 1$ from constraints $\bar{x}_i + \bar{x}_j \geq 1$ in normalised form
- Need this to prove that **at most one vertex per colour class** can be a member of the clique

$$\begin{array}{rcl}
 & \bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_2 \geq 1 & \bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_3 \geq 1 \\
 \text{Add} & \hline
 & 2\bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_2 + \bar{x}_3 \geq 2 & \bar{x}_2 + \bar{x}_3 \geq 1 \\
 \text{Add} & \hline
 & 2\bar{x}_1 + 2\bar{x}_2 + 2\bar{x}_3 \geq 3 \\
 \text{Divide by 2} & \hline
 & \bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_2 + \bar{x}_3 \geq 2
 \end{array}$$

Details on At-Most-One Constraint Recovery (3 Variables)

- Derive constraint $x_1 + \dots + x_n \leq 1$ from $\binom{n}{2}$ constraints $x_i + x_j \leq 1$
- I.e., $\bar{x}_1 + \dots + \bar{x}_n \geq n - 1$ from constraints $\bar{x}_i + \bar{x}_j \geq 1$ in normalised form
- Need this to prove that **at most one vertex per colour class** can be a member of the clique

$$\begin{array}{rcl}
 & \bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_2 \geq 1 & \bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_3 \geq 1 \\
 \text{Add} & \hline
 & 2\bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_2 + \bar{x}_3 \geq 2 & \bar{x}_2 + \bar{x}_3 \geq 1 \\
 \text{Add} & \hline
 & 2\bar{x}_1 + 2\bar{x}_2 + 2\bar{x}_3 \geq 3 \\
 \text{Divide by 2} & \hline
 & \bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_2 + \bar{x}_3 \geq 2
 \end{array}$$

Assuming constraint $\bar{x}_i + \bar{x}_j \geq 1$ has label @C*ij*, get VERIPB code

```
pol @C12 @C13 + @C23 + 2 d ;
```

Details on At-Most-One Constraint Recovery (4 and More Variables)

- Derive constraint $x_1 + \dots + x_n \leq 1$ from $\binom{n}{2}$ constraints $x_i + x_j \leq 1$
- I.e., $\bar{x}_1 + \dots + \bar{x}_n \geq n - 1$ from constraints $\bar{x}_i + \bar{x}_j \geq 1$ in normalised form
- Need this to prove that **at most one vertex per colour class** can be a member of the clique

$$\bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_2 + \bar{x}_3 \geq 2$$

Details on At-Most-One Constraint Recovery (4 and More Variables)

- Derive constraint $x_1 + \dots + x_n \leq 1$ from $\binom{n}{2}$ constraints $x_i + x_j \leq 1$
- I.e., $\bar{x}_1 + \dots + \bar{x}_n \geq n - 1$ from constraints $\bar{x}_i + \bar{x}_j \geq 1$ in normalised form
- Need this to prove that **at most one vertex per colour class** can be a member of the clique

$$\text{Multiply by 2} \quad \frac{\bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_2 + \bar{x}_3 \geq 2}{2\bar{x}_1 + 2\bar{x}_2 + 2\bar{x}_3 \geq 4}$$

Details on At-Most-One Constraint Recovery (4 and More Variables)

- Derive constraint $x_1 + \dots + x_n \leq 1$ from $\binom{n}{2}$ constraints $x_i + x_j \leq 1$
- I.e., $\bar{x}_1 + \dots + \bar{x}_n \geq n - 1$ from constraints $\bar{x}_i + \bar{x}_j \geq 1$ in normalised form
- Need this to prove that **at most one vertex per colour class** can be a member of the clique

$$\begin{array}{rcl}
 \text{Multiply by 2} & \frac{\bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_2 + \bar{x}_3 \geq 2}{2\bar{x}_1 + 2\bar{x}_2 + 2\bar{x}_3 \geq 4} & \bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_4 \geq 1 \\
 \text{Add} & \frac{2\bar{x}_1 + 2\bar{x}_2 + 2\bar{x}_3 \geq 4}{3\bar{x}_1 + 2\bar{x}_2 + 2\bar{x}_3 + \bar{x}_4 \geq 5} & \bar{x}_2 + \bar{x}_4 \geq 1 \\
 \text{Add} & \frac{3\bar{x}_1 + 2\bar{x}_2 + 2\bar{x}_3 + \bar{x}_4 \geq 5}{3\bar{x}_1 + 3\bar{x}_2 + 2\bar{x}_3 + 2\bar{x}_4 \geq 6} & \bar{x}_3 + \bar{x}_4 \geq 1 \\
 \text{Add} & \frac{3\bar{x}_1 + 3\bar{x}_2 + 2\bar{x}_3 + 2\bar{x}_4 \geq 6}{3\bar{x}_1 + 3\bar{x}_2 + 3\bar{x}_3 + 3\bar{x}_4 \geq 7} &
 \end{array}$$

Details on At-Most-One Constraint Recovery (4 and More Variables)

- Derive constraint $x_1 + \dots + x_n \leq 1$ from $\binom{n}{2}$ constraints $x_i + x_j \leq 1$
- I.e., $\bar{x}_1 + \dots + \bar{x}_n \geq n - 1$ from constraints $\bar{x}_i + \bar{x}_j \geq 1$ in normalised form
- Need this to prove that **at most one vertex per colour class** can be a member of the clique

$$\begin{array}{rcl}
 \text{Multiply by 2} & \frac{\bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_2 + \bar{x}_3 \geq 2}{2\bar{x}_1 + 2\bar{x}_2 + 2\bar{x}_3 \geq 4} & \bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_4 \geq 1 \\
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 \text{Add} & \frac{3\bar{x}_1 + 2\bar{x}_2 + 2\bar{x}_3 + \bar{x}_4 \geq 5}{3\bar{x}_1 + 3\bar{x}_2 + 2\bar{x}_3 + 2\bar{x}_4 \geq 6} & \bar{x}_3 + \bar{x}_4 \geq 1 \\
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 \end{array}$$

Details on At-Most-One Constraint Recovery (4 and More Variables)

- Derive constraint $x_1 + \dots + x_n \leq 1$ from $\binom{n}{2}$ constraints $x_i + x_j \leq 1$
- I.e., $\bar{x}_1 + \dots + \bar{x}_n \geq n - 1$ from constraints $\bar{x}_i + \bar{x}_j \geq 1$ in normalised form
- Need this to prove that **at most one vertex per colour class** can be a member of the clique

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 \end{array}$$

Assuming constraint $\bar{x}_i + \bar{x}_j \geq 1$ has label @C_{ij}, VERIPB code for full derivation is

```
pol @C12 @C13 + @C23 + 2 d 2 * @C14 + @C24 + @C34 + 3 d ;
```

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(and this pattern generalizes to any number of variables)

What The Revised Proof with Explicit Counting Looks Like

pseudo-Boolean proof version 3.0

```
@obj soli x7 x9 x12 ;
rup 1 ~x12 1 ~x7 >= 1 ;
pol @noedge1_6 @noedge1_9 + @noedge6_9 + 2 d @obj + ;
rup 1 ~x12 >= 1 ;
pol @noedge1_3 @noedge1_9 + @noedge3_9 + 2 d @obj + ;
rup 1 ~x11 1 ~x10 >= 1 ;
pol @noedge1_3 @noedge1_7 + @noedge3_7 + 2 d @obj + ;
rup 1 ~x11 >= 1 ;
@obj soli x1 x2 x5 x8 ;
rup 1 ~x8 1 ~x5 >= 1 ;
pol @obj @noedge1_9 + ;
rup 1 ~x8 >= 1 ;
pol @noedge1_3 @noedge1_7 + @noedge3_7 + 2 d @noedge2_4 @noedge2_9 + @noedge4_9 + 2 d +
    @noedge5_6 @noedge5_10 + @noedge6_10 + 2 d + @obj + ;
rup >= 1 ;
output NONE ;
conclusion BOUNDS 8 8 ;
end pseudo-Boolean proof ;
```

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pol @noedge1_3 @noedge1_7 + @noedge3_7 + 2 d @obj + ;

rup 1 ~x11 >= 1 ;

@obj soli x1 x2 x5 x8 ;

rup 1 ~x8 1 ~x5 >= 1 ;

pol @obj @noedge1_9 + ;

rup 1 ~x8 >= 1 ;

pol @noedge1_3 @noedge1_7 + @noedge3_7 + 2 d @noedge2_4 @noedge2_9 + @noedge4_9 + 2 d +

@noedge5_6 @noedge5_10 + @noedge6_10 + 2 d + @obj + ;

rup >= 1 ;

output NONE ;

conclusion BOUNDS 8 8 ;

end pseudo-Boolean proof ;

Failing RUP steps have become **pol** derivations: add three non-adjacency constraints together, divide by two, then add the result to the solution-improving constraint

The labels come straight out of the OPB file

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rup 1 ~x8 1 ~x5 >= 1 ;
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```

```
pol @noedge1_3 @noedge1_7 + @noedge3_7 + 2 d @noedge2_4 @noedge2_9 + @noedge4_9 + 2 d +
  @noedge5_6 @noedge5_10 + @noedge6_10 + 2 d + @obj + ;
```

```
rup >= 1 ;
output NONE ;
conclusion BOUNDS 8 8 ;
end pseudo-Boolean proof ;
```

Three colour classes here, so three at-most-one constraints, all added to the solution-improving constraint

Verifying This Proof (For Real, This Time)

```
$ veripb clique.opb clique-new-attempt.pbp
Running VeriPB version 3.0.2
s VERIFIED BOUNDS 8 <= obj <= 8
```

No errors this time — every step is justified

Note that the checker **knows nothing** about

- cliques,
- colourings, or
- bound functions

Verifying This Proof (For Real, This Time)

```
$ veripb --trace clique.opb clique-new-attempt.pbp
Running VeriPB version 3.0.2
Objective: min 1 ~x1 1 ~x2 . . . 1 ~x11 1 ~x12 0
ConstraintId 1: 1 ~x1 1 ~x3 >= 1
. . .
ConstraintId 41: 1 ~x11 1 ~x12 >= 1
line 2: @obj soli x7 x9 x12 ;
ConstraintId 42: 1 x1 1 x2 . . . 1 x11 1 x12 >= 4
line 3: rup 1 ~x12 1 ~x7 >= 1 ;
ConstraintId 43: 1 ~x7 1 ~x12 >= 1
line 4: pol @noedge1_6 @noedge1_9 + @noedge6_9 + 2 d @obj + ;
ConstraintId 44: 1 x2 1 x3 1 x4 1 x5 1 x7 1 x8 1 x10 1 x11 1 x12 >= 3
. . .
line 16: rup >= 1 ;
ConstraintId 55: >= 1
s VERIFIED BOUNDS 8 <= obj <= 8
```

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Why not just put a “colouring bound” rule into the proof format?

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Cutting planes proof system to the rescue!

- Turns out to be strong enough for all of these cases
- Proof length scales linearly with solver reasoning time (asymptotically)

Different Clique Algorithms

Different search orders?

- ✓ Irrelevant for proof logging

Using local search to initialise?

- ✓ Just log the incumbent

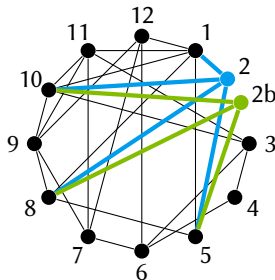
Different bound functions?

- Is cutting planes strong enough to justify every useful bound function ever invented?
- So far, seems like it...

Weighted cliques?

- ✓ Multiply a colour class by its largest weight
- ✓ Also works for vertices “split between colour classes”

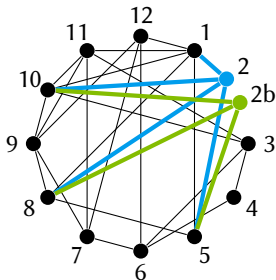
Lazy Global Domination for Maximum Clique [MP16]



Can ignore vertex 2b

- Every neighbour of 2b is also a neighbour of 2
- This is an example of **dominance** reasoning

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Dominance-based strengthening rule can justify this

- Even when detected dynamically during search

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We are still trusting rather a lot

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 - reads the **original graph file**
 - does a **formally verified translation to 0-1 ILP**
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- So the answer is formally verified in terms of the original input

End-to-End Verification for Maximum Clique

```
$ glasgow_clique_solver brock200_4.clq
recursions = 56613
clique = 17 (12 19 28 29 38 54 65 71 79 93 117 127 139 161 165 186 192)
runtime = 0.02153s

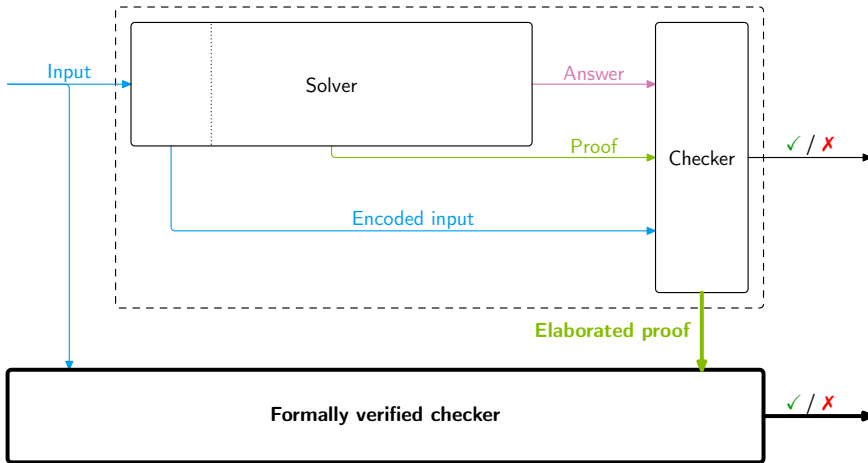
$ glasgow_clique_solver brock200_4.clq --prove brock200_4
runtime = 0.266475s

$ cake_pb_clique brock200_4.clq > brock200_4.verifiedopb

$ veripb --elaborate brock200_4.corepb brock200_4.verifiedopb brock200_4.pbp
s VERIFIED BOUNDS 183 <= obj <= 183

$ cake_pb_clique brock200_4.clq brock200_4.corepb
s VERIFIED MAX CLIQUE SIZE |CLIQUE| = 17
```

Workflow for Solving with End-to-End Certified Results



What's Left to Trust?

Still have to trust:

- The HOL4 theorem prover
- That the formal model of the CAKEML environment matches the hardware it runs on
- The HOL4 definition of what it means to be a maximum clique
- Input parsing and output formatting

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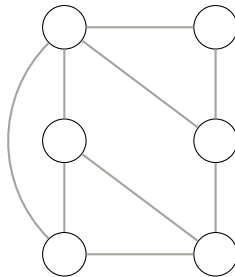
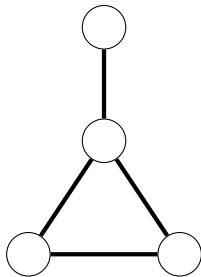
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No need to trust, or even to know about:

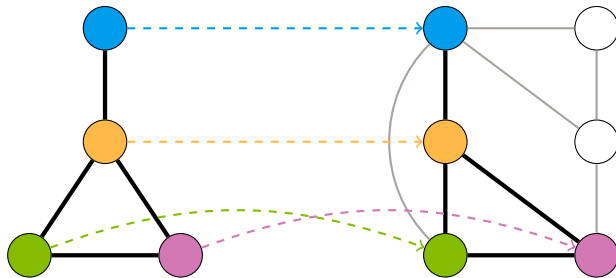
- How the solver works
- That the VERIPB proof system is sound
- Or even what “pseudo-Boolean” means

Subgraph Isomorphism



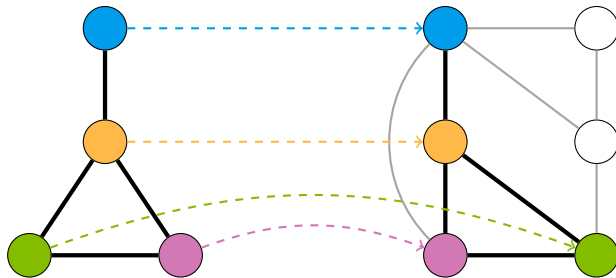
- Find the **pattern** inside the **target**
- Applications in compilers, biochemistry, model checking, pattern recognition, ...
- Often want to find **all** matches

Subgraph Isomorphism



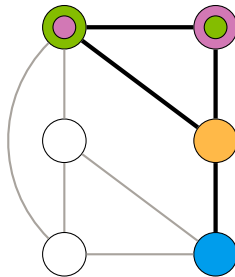
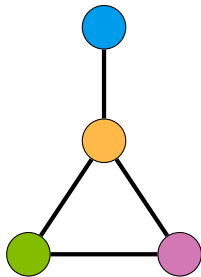
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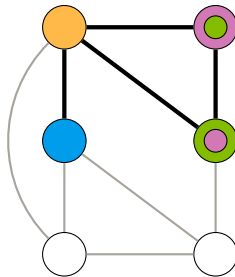
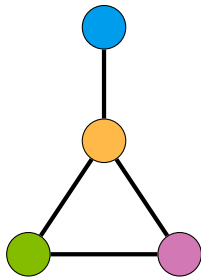
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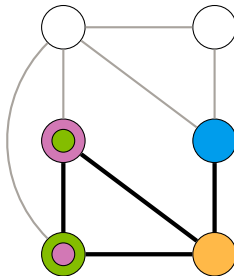
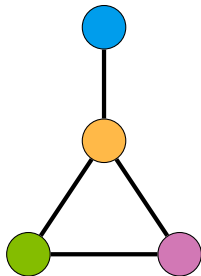
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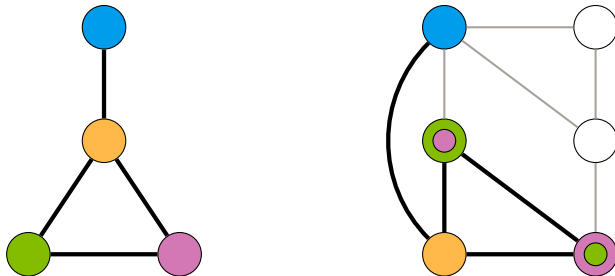
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Subgraph Isomorphism in Pseudo-Boolean Form

Each pattern vertex gets a target vertex:

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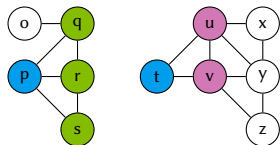
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Adjacency constraints: if p maps to t , then neighbours of p map to neighbours of t :

$$\bar{x}_{p,t} + \sum_{u \in N(t)} x_{q,u} \geq 1 \quad p \in V(P), q \in N(p), t \in V(T)$$

Degree Reasoning in Cutting Planes

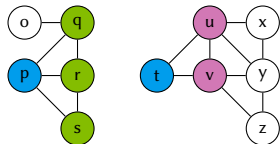


Pattern vertex p of degree $\deg(p)$ can never be mapped to target vertex t of degree $< \deg(p)$

Observe $N(p) = \{q, r, s\}$ and $N(t) = \{u, v\}$

We wish to derive $\bar{x}_{p,t} \geq 1$

Degree Reasoning in Cutting Planes



Adjacency:

$$\bar{x}_{p,t} + x_{q,u} + x_{q,v} \geq 1$$

$$\bar{x}_{p,t} + x_{r,u} + x_{r,v} \geq 1$$

$$\bar{x}_{p,t} + x_{s,u} + x_{s,v} \geq 1$$

Injectivity:

$$-x_{o,u} + -x_{p,u} + -x_{q,u} + -x_{r,u} + -x_{s,u} \geq -1$$

$$-x_{o,v} + -x_{p,v} + -x_{q,v} + -x_{r,v} + -x_{s,v} \geq -1$$

Literal axioms:

$$x_{o,u} \geq 0$$

$$x_{o,v} \geq 0$$

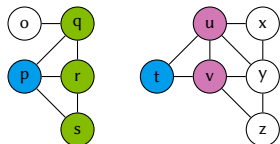
$$x_{p,u} \geq 0$$

$$x_{p,v} \geq 0$$

Add these together ...

$$3 \cdot \bar{x}_{p,t} \geq 1$$

Degree Reasoning in Cutting Planes



Adjacency:

$$\bar{x}_{p,t} + x_{q,u} + x_{q,v} \geq 1$$

$$\bar{x}_{p,t} + x_{r,u} + x_{r,v} \geq 1$$

$$\bar{x}_{p,t} + x_{s,u} + x_{s,v} \geq 1$$

Injectivity:

$$-x_{o,u} + -x_{p,u} + -x_{q,u} + -x_{r,u} + -x_{s,u} \geq -1$$

$$-x_{o,v} + -x_{p,v} + -x_{q,v} + -x_{r,v} + -x_{s,v} \geq -1$$

Literal axioms:

$$x_{o,u} \geq 0$$

$$x_{o,v} \geq 0$$

$$x_{p,u} \geq 0$$

$$x_{p,v} \geq 0$$

Add these together and divide by 3 to get

$$\bar{x}_{p,t} \geq 1$$

Degree Reasoning in VERIPB

```
pol @adj_p_t_q @adj_p_t_r + @adj_p_t_s + % sum adjacency constraints
    @inj_u + @inj_v + % sum injectivity constraints
    xo_u + xo_v + % cancel stray xo_* >= 0
    xp_u + xp_v + % cancel stray xp_* >= 0
    3 d ; % divide, and we're done
```

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    3 d ;                                       % divide, and we're done
```

The labels come from the OPB file, so solver doesn't need to keep track of constraint IDs

Possible to certify (almost) all of the other things state-of-the-art subgraph solvers do:

- Conditional injectivity reasoning and filtering
- Distance filtering
- Neighbourhood degree sequences
- Path filtering
- Supplemental graphs

- ### ■ Supplemental graphs

Proof Logging for Other Forms of Reasoning

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Proof steps are “efficient” using cutting planes

- Length of proof scales linearly with time complexity of the reasoning algorithms
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Code for the certifying *Glasgow Subgraph Solver* at

<https://github.com/ciaranm/glasgow-subgraph-solver>

Limitations

Why trust the encoding?

- ✓ For clique and subgraph isomorphism this is now taken care of [GMM⁺24]
 - Has to be done again for each new problem, but not too bad

Proof logging can introduce large slowdowns

- Writing to disk is much slower than bit-parallel algorithms

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Works up to moderately-sized hard instances

- Even an $O(n^3)$ encoding is painful
- Particularly bad when the pseudo-Boolean encoding talks about “non-edges” but large sparse graphs are “easy”

What About Constraint Programming?

Non-Boolean variables?

Constraints?

- Encoding constraints in pseudo-Boolean form?
- Justifying inferences?

Reformulations?

Integer Variables in Constraint Programming (1/2)

How to deal with integer variables in constraint programming?

Given $A \in \{-3, \dots, 9\}$, the direct encoding is:

$$\begin{aligned}
 &a_{=-3} + a_{=-2} + a_{=-1} + a_{=0} + a_{=1} + a_{=2} + a_{=3} \\
 &\quad + a_{=4} + a_{=5} + a_{=6} + a_{=7} + a_{=8} + a_{=9} = 1
 \end{aligned}$$

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This doesn't work for large domains...

We could use a binary encoding:

$$\begin{aligned} -16a_{\text{neg}} + 1a_{b0} + 2a_{b1} + 4a_{b2} + 8a_{b3} &\geq -3 && \text{and} \\ 16a_{\text{neg}} + -1a_{b0} + -2a_{b1} + -4a_{b2} + -8a_{b3} &\geq -9 \end{aligned}$$

Bad properties for solver propagation, but that isn't a problem for proof logging

Convention in what follows:

- Upper-case A, B, C are **CP variables** used by solver
- Lower-case a, b, c are **corresponding Boolean variables** used for PB encoding in proof log

Integer Variables in Constraint Programming (2/2)

We can mix binary and order encodings! Define big-M linear inequalities encoding

$$a_{\geq 4} \Leftrightarrow -16a_{\text{neg}} + 1a_{b0} + 2a_{b1} + 4a_{b2} + 8a_{b3} \geq 4$$

$$a_{\geq 5} \Leftrightarrow -16a_{\text{neg}} + 1a_{b0} + 2a_{b1} + 4a_{b2} + 8a_{b3} \geq 5$$

$$a_{=4} \Leftrightarrow a_{\geq 4} \wedge \bar{a}_{\geq 5}$$

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When creating $a_{\geq i}$, also introduce pseudo-Boolean constraints encoding

$$a_{\geq i} \Rightarrow a_{\geq j} \quad \text{and} \quad a_{\geq h} \Rightarrow a_{\geq i}$$

for the closest values $j < i < h$ that already exist

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We can do this:

- Inside the pseudo-Boolean model where needed
- Otherwise lazily during proof logging

Compiling Constraints

- Also need to compile every constraint to pseudo-Boolean form
- Doesn't need to be a propagating encoding
- Can use additional variables

where $A, B, C \in \{-3, \dots, 9\}$

Compiling Linear Inequalities

Given inequality

$$2A + 3B + 4C \geq 42$$

where $A, B, C \in \{-3, \dots, 9\}$

Encode in pseudo-Boolean form as

$$\begin{aligned} & -32a_{\text{neg}} + 2a_{b0} + 4a_{b1} + 8a_{b2} + 16a_{b3} \\ & + -48b_{\text{neg}} + 3b_{b0} + 6b_{b1} + 12b_{b2} + 24b_{b3} \\ & + -64c_{\text{neg}} + 4c_{b0} + 8c_{b1} + 16c_{b2} + 32c_{b3} \geq 42 \end{aligned}$$

Compiling Table Constraints

Constraints can be specified **extensionally** as list of feasible tuples, called a **table**
Variable assignments must match some row in table

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Constraints can be specified **extensionally** as list of feasible tuples, called a **table**
Variable assignments must match some row in table

Given table constraint

$$(A, B, C) \in [(1, 2, 3), (1, 3, 4), (2, 2, 5)]$$

define

$$3\bar{t}_1 + a_{=1} + b_{=2} + c_{=3} \geq 3$$

$$\text{i.e., } t_1 \Rightarrow (a_{=1} \wedge b_{=2} \wedge c_{=3})$$

$$3\bar{t}_2 + a_{=1} + b_{=3} + c_{=4} \geq 3$$

$$\text{i.e., } t_2 \Rightarrow (a_{=1} \wedge b_{=3} \wedge c_{=4})$$

$$3\bar{t}_3 + a_{=2} + b_{=2} + c_{=5} \geq 3$$

$$\text{i.e., } t_3 \Rightarrow (a_{=2} \wedge b_{=2} \wedge c_{=5})$$

using newly introduced tuple selector variables

$$t_1 + t_2 + t_3 = 1$$

Encoding Constraint Definitions

Already know how to do it for any constraint with a sane encoding using some combination of

- CNF
- Integer linear inequalities
- Table constraints
- Auxiliary variables

Simplicity is important, propagation strength isn't

Justifying Search

Mostly this works out of the box

Restarts are easy

No need to prove anything about guesses/decisions – only justify backtracking

Justifying Inference

Key idea

Anything the constraint programming solver knows must follow from **unit propagation** of guessed assignments on **constraints in proof log**

Justifying Inference

Key idea

Anything the constraint programming solver knows must follow from **unit propagation** of guessed assignments on **constraints in proof log**

- If it follows from unit propagation on the encoding, nothing needed
- Some propagators and encodings need RUP steps for inferences
 - A lot of propagators are effectively “doing a little bit of lookahead” but in an efficient way

$$Z \in \{1, 3\}$$

$$V \in \{1 \quad 4 \quad 5\}$$

$$W \in \{1 \ 2 \ 3 \}$$

$$X \in \{ \quad 2 \quad 3 \quad \}$$

$$Y \in \{1, 3\}$$

$$Z \in \{1, 3\}$$

$$Z \in \{1, 3\}$$

Justifying All-Different Failures

$$V \in \{1 \quad 4 \quad 5\}$$

$$W \in \{1 \quad 2 \quad 3 \quad \quad \quad \} \quad w_{=1} + w_{=2} + w_{=3} \geq 1 \quad [W \text{ takes some value}]$$

$$X \in \{ \quad 2 \quad 3 \quad \quad \quad \} \quad x_{=2} + x_{=3} \geq 1 \quad [X \text{ takes some value}]$$

$$Y \in \{1 \quad 3 \quad \quad \quad \} \quad y_{=1} + y_{=3} \geq 1 \quad [Y \text{ takes some value}]$$

$$Z \in \{1 \quad 3 \quad \quad \quad \} \quad z_{=1} + z_{=3} \geq 1 \quad [Z \text{ takes some value}]$$

$$\rightarrow \quad -v_{=1} + -w_{=1} + \quad -y_{=1} + -z_{=1} \geq -1 \quad [\text{At most one variable} = 1]$$

$$\rightarrow \quad \quad -w_{=2} + -x_{=2} \geq -1 \quad [\text{At most one variable} = 2]$$

$$\rightarrow \quad \quad -w_{=3} + -x_{=3} + -y_{=3} + -z_{=3} \geq -1 \quad [\text{At most one variable} = 3]$$

$$-v_{=1} \geq 1 \quad [\text{Sum all constraints so far}]$$

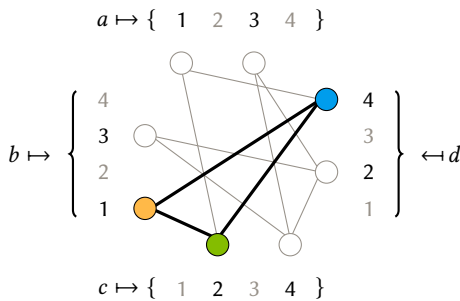
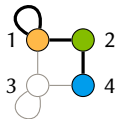
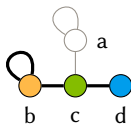
Topics '26 73/79

Reformulation

Auto-tabulation is possible

- Heavy use of extension variables

Can re-encode max common subgraph as clique problem without changing PB encoding



High Level Modelling Languages?

High level modelling languages like `MINIZINC` and `ESSENCE` have complicated compilers

How do we know we're giving a proof for the problem the user actually specified?

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How do we know we're giving a proof for the problem the user actually specified?

We don't

Need modelling language with formally specified semantics...

The *Glasgow* Constraint Solver

Support for 37 (families of) constraints (and counting), with all inferences certified:

Abs, AllDifferent, AllEqual, Among, AtMostOne, BinPacking, Circuit, Comparison, Count, Cumulative, Diffn, Disjunctive, DivMod, Element, Equals, GCC, In, Increasing, Inverse, Knapsack, Lex, Linear, Logical, MDD, MinDistance, MinMax, Multiply, NValue, Parity, PlusMinus, Power, Regular, SeqPrecedeChain, SmartTable, Sort, Table, ValuePrecede

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Extract information implied by scheduling problem constraints

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- Capacity strengthening by integrality, conflict cliques across resources, lifted cover cuts:
Extract information implied by scheduling problem constraints
- Difference logic: Spot that a pile of two-term inequalities is a precedence network, and hand to temporal propagator

Future Research Directions

Performance of pseudo-Boolean proof logging and checking

- Faster proof logging and checking!
- Trim proofs while checking as in SAT solving [HHW13] (*very recent work [ABB⁺26a]*)
- Compress proof files using binary format

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Proof logging for other combinatorial problems and techniques

- Model counting
- Mixed integer linear programming (*suggested extension of VERIPB in [DEGH23]*)
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- Use proof logs for algorithm analysis or explainability purposes
- Lots of other challenging problems and interesting ideas

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And more...

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- Lots of other challenging problems and interesting ideas
- Talk to me if you want to join the pseudo-Boolean proof logging revolution! 😊
We're happy to [collaborate](#), and [we're hiring](#)

Reminder about VeriPB Resources



VeriPB [tutorials, technical documentation, and more information](#) at
<https://VeriPB.org>

Tutorial series with [videos and slides](#) from *WHOOPS* '25 workshop at
<https://jakobnordstrom.se/WHOOPS25/>

[Technical details on different proof logging techniques](#) covered in research papers
[EGMN20, GMN20, GMM⁺20, GN21, GMN22, GMNO22, VDB22, BBN⁺23, BGMN23, MM23,
BBN⁺24, DMM⁺24, GMM⁺24, HOGN24, IOT⁺24, MMN24, DHN⁺25, JBBJ25, KLM⁺25, MM25,
ABB⁺26a, ABB⁺26b, DKK⁺26, MNOT26, VCB26] and PhD theses [Goc22, Mcl26, Oer26]

Lots of [concrete example files](#) at <https://gitlab.com/MIAOresearch/software/VeriPB>

Summing up

Second lecture

- More technical details on VERIPB
- Some convenient syntactic sugar (labels and reification)
- Example applications
 - 1 Maximum clique
 - 2 Subgraph isomorphism
 - 3 Constraint programming

Main message

- Combinatorial solvers are amazing, but **ensuring correctness is crucial**
- **Certifying solvers** producing **machine-verifiable proofs** is the most promising approach
- **Pseudo-Boolean proof logging** has been surprisingly successful in moving the research frontier forward

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Thank you for your attention!

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